MCP

Title:
H for Hercules

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Hercules, a large middle-aged man, steps onto the stage.

Mmmhmm.. Yup all gone. See?

(*Opens mouth. A beat, then he spits out the pill hiding in the side of his mouth*)

Oh, well hi there? You're new here aren't you? Well hi, my name's.. uh…. uh… You know I think it starts with an H. Henry, or Harrison, or.. well it doesn't really matter. So whatchya in here for?

What ain't you gonna talk? You're not deaf or something are you? (tests audience hearing) Well fine. If you ain't gonna talk then I'll just have to do the talking for the both of us. I love to talk.
Hell, talkin' is my favorite thing. Or at least it is one of my favorite things. You see I like to find new favorite things; it keeps life interesting. That's what I'm here for: liking things. My favorite things.

So what kind of pills do you have to take? I have to take these blue ones with a white stripe, and well, they's the reason I can't remember my name. My doctors all tell me "Well we can tell you your name" and I tell them "nope! H is fine thank you". H is the best letter as far as I'm concerned. Do you have a favorite letter?

Well what about a favorite thing? Really? You still ain't gonna talk? Ok. Well I'll tell you what my newest favorite thing is. It's great. It's this brand new thing called Netflix. Now I know what you're thinking: "Now H, Netflix ain't a new thing; it's been around for a real long long time now". No it ain't. I ain't never heard about before so it's new to me. And you wanna know what my favorite thing to watch is? Hercules. Oh I love that movie. You see Hercules is the story of a young man who is forced to drink poison because of the devil and has to save the life of a girl, ALL TO BECOME A HERO! I love that movie.

I used to watch it all the time with my little girl.

You see it was her favorite movie too, 'cause her name is Meg just like the girl from the movie's name is Meg. I don't… I don't like talking about her too much..

uh…. I'm sorry. I get sort of emotional on account of these pills. Not the blue ones with the white stripe but these other ones. These white ones. You know, the ones I just "took". I don't like those pills. Those pills make me feel sad. They make me feel weak. And I tell my doctors "I don't want to feel sad or weak… and.. and you can't make me!". My wife used to make me feel sad and weak. That's what lead me to find one of my, other, favorite things.

Alcohol.

You see alcohol was what made me feel like Hercules. I could take anything that my devil of a wife would hash out at me. But then she wised up… she learned she couldn't hurt me anymore so she…. she… ahhh that doesn't matter. You know? I like you. I'm glad we're best friends now. My doctor keeps telling me I should make more friends. Jesus it's like I'm a little kid again. I probably said the exact same thing to my little Meghan. She always had problems making friends. I think it was because of my wife. She'd always put her down, make her feel bad about herself. I remember there was this one time she was yellin' at meg for something she did. She was yellin' because Meg didn't do something just right, it wasn't perfect. I remember getting out of my chair and saying "Yeah? Hell, when have you ever been called perfect?".

You wanna know what my wife did then? My devil of a wife? She looked me right in the eyes and said:

(*as his wife*)
"If you ever tell me how to treat my daughter again. If you EVER talk back to me again… I'll call the police. I'll call 'em up and tell them that you just hit me and that you'd been threatening to hit me ever since we been married. You wanna see your little girl again? Then SHUT. UP."

I bet you could guess what I did then?

Nothin'. I. Did. Nothin'. I drank my anger away. Then my wife did something that... shook me to the core. She turned to my little girl and said:

(*as his wife*) "You see that Meghan? Your daddy's no hero. No he's a sad drunk. He's sorry excuse for a man."

I like to think that I'm nice man. Always treated my little girl like the princess she is, even when I was drunk. But when my wife said that. Something in me just...

Snapped. I got up out of my chair, went up to my wife and said “You wanna tell the cops I hit you? Fine. Let’s give you something to talk about.” And I hit her. I hit her over, and over, and over again, and I couldn’t stop. My little girl is grabbing my leg screaming.

(*as his daughter*) “Daddy stop it! She didn’t mean it! JUST STOP!”

But I couldn’t stop. I had to beat the devil. And that’s what I told my lawyer. I told him I had to beat the devil; and my lawyer told the judge I was not “competent enough” to knowingly hurt someone. That my “delusions” was brought on by my addiction to alcohol. That’s why I’m here! That’s why I can’t ever see my little girl again. That’s why to her, I’ll never be a hero. I’ll never be Hercules. Well you know I may not be Hercules; but I know how he feels. I know what it feels like to be ripped out of your home, forced to drink poison because of some devil, and how hopeless it can feel when you’re trying to save somebody you care about.

(*Chuckles*)
Hell, maybe I am Hercules, I don’t know. But what I do know is, is that I like you and I like this whole talking thing. Who knows? Maybe this, is going to be one of my new favorite things.

END